

source goes a long way. A lot of malware is installed as a result of people not taking care about the kind of software they give permission to run on their systems. Whenever downloading any such thing, go to the verified site first, and avoid using any external links that redirect you to the “official” site. Even if you don’t use the internet much, viruses and malware now have a way of spreading through pen drives and external HDDs. This doesn’t need much effort from the hackers’ side - they’ll simply disguise the virus as an executable having a recognisable name; even if the virus might not be a software, the common trend in many infected disks is to create a shortcut that contains all your files that were previously visible in your external disk. When you try to open any of the folders, the virus automatically gets executed and infects your PC. The best and only way to get rid of such viruses is to get your anti-virus to scan the infected drive and have it weed out the virus. The best way to go would be to scan any external drive that’s inserted into your device, no matter how trusted the source is.

Where’s that free Wi-Fi?

One particularly prevalent and unavoidable issue is the use of public Wi-Fi hotspots. The very convenience that makes public Wi-Fi so attractive is what is probably its downside. The fact that public networks require no authentication to establish a connection is what allows hacker to get unrestricted and unlimited access to unsecured devices on the same network. Since there is no password or passphrase to encrypt the information being sent to and fro between the router and the device, any hacker can use software to intercept those signals at which point they can see everything on a fellow



Understanding how a VPN works